push for *ek gaon, ek kuan, ek shamshan* (one village, one well and one crematorium).

However, despite the Congress campaign remaining relatively low-key, the BJP fears it is working silently at the grassroots level, something Modi has been warning of in his speeches. Another BJP leader says the Congress is working on the KHAM (Kshatriya, Harijan, Adivasi, Muslim) formula perfected by Solanki to win his record mandate. The BJP also has to contend with a rising AAP. Though top BJP leaders dismiss its campaign as just bluster, partymen do concede that AAP is beginning to make inroads into the state. Especially after Kejriwal announced a spate of freebies, including free water and electricity supply to farmers, Rs 3,000 to every unemployed youth till they get jobs, besides free healthcare and education. And though the prime minister called out the '*revdi* culture' in August without naming AAP, in his five visits to Gujarat between then and the imposition of the model code of conduct on November 3, he inaugurated or announced a bonanza of infrastructural projects, social welfare schemes and other sops, which total Rs 79,000 crore, for the state. Then, there's the Atmanirbhar Gujarat scheme to boost capital and power subsidies to micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). For the powerful cooperatives in the state, the Centre reformulated a policy so that tax liability of Rs 8,000 crore could be waived for the state's 1.5-2 million sugar cultivators. Meanwhile, to address unemployment in the state, the BJP government been tom-tomming a big push for industry. This includes the announcement that the Vedanta-Foxconn semiconductor plant was coming up in Dholera and a Tata-Airbus manufacturing unit in Vadodara. In October, Modi inaugurated India's first bulk drug manufacturing plant in Bharuch. All these initiatives find mention in the campaign speeches to demonstrate that the government is creating a number of jobs in the state.

STRATEGY IN MOTION

Despite the tide being in the BJP's favour, Modi & Co are leaving nothing to chance and pulling out all the stops to woo voters. In addition to massive rallies, the prime minister is also planning door-to-door campaigning. Bharat Pandya, a former MLA and Modi's greenroom boy, told INDIA TODAY, "We believe in three Vs for victory—*vichaar* (ideology), *vatavaran* (environment) and *vyavastha* (organisation)." Modi, with his run of rallies, has lent a touch of electricity to the environment that has energised the party's well-oiled election machinery, with 1.04 million *panna pramukh*s and 1.09 million cadre manning all 52,000 booths across the state. The party has also activated its *pravasi* (outstation) leaders to beef up the organisational teams. They have been asked to anchor outreach programmes, man Shakti Kendras as well as devise and execute booth-level activities while mobilising resources on the ground. Around 150 senior party leaders, Union ministers, chief ministers and leaders from other states have been roped in for the 'carpet-bombing campaign'. There is also an outreach programme to woo the large diaspora with the BJP's overseas wing persuading them to back party candidates in their respective spheres of influence. The BJP strategy of deploying *panna samiti*s (voter page committees), which paid handsome dividends in Uttar Pradesh, is also being used in Gujarat.

WHETHER IN THE DIGITAL REALM OR AT THE RALLIES AND IN THE DOOR-TO-DOOR CAMPAIGNS—THE CENTRAL THEME REMAINS THE SAME: IT'S MODI VS THE REST. THE PM CONTINUES TO BE THE TALISMAN THAT THE BJP HOPES WILL HELP IT WIN

Meanwhile, the party has set up digital war rooms across the state. Lined with desktops, they have dozens of young people poring over their screens, while multiple television sets hooked on the walls play regional or even a few national news channels. Eyeballs and fingers are constantly moving, as these youth work round the clock, keeping in direct touch with voters virtually and controlling the narrative in the digital space. The BJP has a strict standardised creative language that every candidate has to follow. Social media handles of all candidates are centrally controlled to maintain uniformity. The candidate is expected to focus on campaigning while the central team manages the outreach. Programmed ads play ceaselessly. BJP sources say they put out more than 100,000 WhatsApp groups to amplify the party's message. The party's central digital media management team also provides candidates with videographers and photographers to facilitate real-time updates on social media. Sources indicate that a candidate spends a minimum of 10-15 per cent of his total poll expenditure on digital presence.

But whether in the digital realm or at the rallies and in the door-to-door campaigns—the central theme remains the same: it's Modi vs the Rest. The prime minister continues to be the talisman that the BJP hopes will help it win. Hence, everything that is being done in the Gujarat campaign is being done in the name of Modi. ■